

The Four Labour Codes Consolidated - The Foundation Track

Chapter F2.9 — Every Threshold as an Old-Act / New-Code Pair, What Is Genuinely New, and What Was Abolished

Module	Foundation Layer — Module 2 — Labour Laws and Industrial Relations
Chapter	Chapter F2.9
Topic	Official syllabus head 5 — Industrial Relations and Labour Laws
Version	v1.0
Compiled	9 August 2026
Exam stage	Recruitment Test (RT)

NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

This is the revision spine for the whole of Module 2. It teaches no new statute. Instead it assembles every threshold, rate and time limit you have met in Chapters F2.1 to F2.8 into a single set of OLD ACT / NEW CODE pairs, separates what the Codes genuinely INVENTED from what they merely consolidated, records what they ABOLISHED, and states the case for and against the reform fairly. Your 2026 paper is the first APFC paper sat under a fully operating Code regime, while every past paper you can practise on was set under the parent Acts - which is precisely why the pairs matter more than either column alone. Study time 4 hours. Read this chapter once now, and then again in your final week.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. Where a Code figure could not be verified against the Gazette or the Central Rules notified 8 May 2026, it is marked CONFIRM and the old-Act figure is given as the safer answer. No figure has been invented to complete a table.

Table of Contents

0. Why This Chapter Exists	3
1. The Master Threshold Table ★★★★★	4
2. What the Codes Genuinely INVENTED ★★★★★	6
3. What the Codes ABOLISHED ★★★★★☆	7
4. The 2026 Central Rules - the operative numbers ★★★★★	7
5. The Case For and Against ★★★★★☆	8
6. Graded Practice - 40 Questions ★★★★★	10
6.1 Level 1 - Recognition	10
6.2 Level 2 - Understanding	11
6.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard	12
7. Answers and Explanations	14
7.1 Level 1	14
7.2 Level 2	14
7.3 Level 3	15
8. One-Minute Revision	16
9. Five-Minute Wall Sheet	16

0. Why This Chapter Exists

You are in an unusual position. Every past paper you can practise on was set under the old Acts. Your own paper will be the first set under the Codes. So you need both columns, and you need to know which is which.

MUST MASTER · THE REGIME CHANGE, AND THE FOUR DATES

- 1 The **Code on Wages** was passed in **2019**; the other three Codes in **2020**
- 2 All four were brought **into force on 21 November 2025**
- 3 **Final Central Rules** were notified on **8 May 2026**
- 4 **Twenty-nine** central labour Acts were replaced

So the 2023 paper, and the 2025 paper sat nine days after commencement, were both effectively set on the parent Acts. Your 2026 paper is the first under a fully operating Code regime.

What that means for how you answer:

- 1 If a question **names the old Act** - "under the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947..." - give the **old** figure
- 2 If it **names a Code**, or says "as amended", or "at present" - give the **Code** figure
- 3 If the stem is **bare** and the two differ, prefer the **Code** figure for a 2026 paper, but read once more for any statutory name
- 4 Where the two are the **same**, which is more often than candidates expect, the question is not testing the change at all

MEMORY TECHNIQUE · 4 - 3 - 9 - 13

Code	Acts	Territory
Code on Wages, 2019	4	Minimum wages, payment of wages, bonus, equal remuneration
Industrial Relations Code, 2020	3	Trade unions, standing orders, industrial disputes
Code on Social Security, 2020	9	EPF, ESI, gratuity, maternity benefit, employees' compensation, cess, unorganised, gig and platform workers - your Code
Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020	13	Factories, mines, dock work, construction, contract labour, inter-state migrants, plantations, and more

4 + 3 + 9 + 13 = 29. Ascending order of Acts replaced, which makes the sequence easy to hold. The **Wages Code is the only one of 2019**; the other three are of **2020**.

1. The Master Threshold Table ★★★★★

This is the single most valuable page in Module 2 for revision. Learn the pairs, and note carefully which rows did not change.

MUST MASTER · PART 1 - THE THRESHOLDS THAT CHANGED

Provision	Old	New	Note
Factory - with power	10	20	OSH Code doubled it
Factory - without power	20	40	Also doubled
Standing orders	100	300	The first of the two 100-to-300 changes
Prior permission for lay-off, retrenchment, closure	100	300	The second . Different subject, same numbers
Contract labour - establishment	20	50	Also for the contractor's licence
Creche	30 women	50 employees	Criterion changed from women to employees
Supervisory wage limit in "worker"	Rs 10,000	Rs 18,000	IR Code, or as notified
Leave qualifying days - factories	240	180	Accrual 1 in 20 retained
Gratuity - fixed-term employee	5 years	1 year	The most examinable single change
Claims limitation - wages	short	3 years	A substantial extension
Notice of strike	14 days	14 days	Rate unchanged , but extended from public utility only to ALL establishments

OLD = parent Act · NEW = Code

MUST MASTER · PART 2 - THE THRESHOLDS THAT DID NOT CHANGE, WHICH IS WHERE CANDIDATES LOSE MARKS

Provision	Figure	Note
EPF coverage	20	Co-operative society without power 50
ESI coverage	10	Unchanged
Bonus applicability	20	Unchanged
Bonus eligibility ceiling	Rs 21,000	Unchanged
Bonus calculation ceiling	Rs 7,000	Or the minimum wage, whichever higher
EPF wage ceiling	Rs 15,000	Now worded "as notified" - see Module 3
Maternity Benefit	10	Unchanged
Works Committee	100	Unchanged; maximum 20 members
Inter-state migrant workmen	5	Threshold same, but the definition widened to include self-migrants
Building and construction workers	10	Unchanged
Rest rooms - factories	150	Unchanged
Ambulance room	500	Unchanged
Safety Committee - hazardous process	50	Unchanged
Grievance Redressal Committee	20	Strengthened under the Code; maximum 10 members

Learn these as *UNCHANGED* - the commonest false assumption about the Codes

Fourteen rows unchanged against eleven changed. A candidate who assumes everything moved will get more questions wrong than one who assumes nothing did. **The Codes changed far fewer numbers than the reform's publicity suggests.**

IMPORTANT · THREE FIGURES MARKED CONFIRM - AND WHY I HAVE NOT SIMPLY PRINTED THEM

The **canteen**, **Safety Officer** and **Welfare Officer** thresholds under the OSH Code and its Rules are **reported** as reduced from the Factories Act figures, but I could not verify them against the notified Rules with the confidence the rest of this table carries.

So the table gives both columns and marks them CONFIRM, rather than printing a figure I cannot stand behind. If the stem names the **Factories Act, 1948**, answer **250 canteen, 500 Welfare Officer, 1,000 Safety Officer** - those are certain. If it names the **OSH Code**, verify before the RT.

This is the same discipline applied to the **Mines Act Special Officer notice period** in Chapter F2.7, which remains the only figure in Module 2 left entirely blank.

2. What the Codes Genuinely INVENTED ★★★★★

Most of the four Codes is consolidation - old provisions re-numbered. A much shorter list is genuinely new, and that shorter list is where the questions concentrate.

MUST MASTER · THE NINE GENUINE INNOVATIONS

- 1 **The uniform definition of "wages" with the 50 per cent rule.** One definition across all four Codes; excluded allowances may not exceed half of total remuneration, and the excess is added back. **This is the most important change in the entire reform** - it recalculates provident fund, gratuity, bonus and every other wage-linked liability. Chapter F2.1
- 2 **The floor wage**, fixed by the **Central Government**, below which no State may set a minimum wage - plus **universal coverage**, with scheduled employments abolished. Chapter F2.5
- 3 **Fixed-term employment** - a written contract for a fixed period, with full pro-rata parity, **gratuity after one year**, and **no retrenchment on mere expiry**. Chapter F2.4
- 4 **The negotiating union and negotiating council** - **51 per cent** for sole recognition, **20 per cent** for a council seat, one representative per 20 per cent. This finally fills the recognition gap the Trade Unions Act 1926 left open for ninety years. Chapter F2.2
- 5 **Gig workers, platform workers and aggregators** - defined for the first time, with an **aggregator contribution of 1 to 2 per cent of turnover**, capped at **5 per cent** of payments made to such workers. Module 3
- 6 **The Worker Re-skilling Fund** - **15 days' wages** on retrenchment, credited within **10 days**, paid to the worker within **45 days**, **in addition to** retrenchment compensation. Chapter F2.3
- 7 **The Inspector-cum-Facilitator**, replacing the Inspector, with **web-based randomised** inspection and a facilitation as well as an enforcement role
- 8 **Mandatory appointment letters** for every employee - a small provision with large formalisation consequences, because a worker without a letter cannot easily prove employment
- 9 **Single registration, single licence, single return** - including a **single all-India contractor licence** valid five years, and a **single register** in place of the many required by the repealed Acts

And two further innovations on the migrant and core-activity side: the widened **migrant worker** definition covering those who migrate on their own, with **portability** and a national database; and the prohibition of contract labour in **core activities**, with a defined list of non-core services.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHICH SINGLE INNOVATION SHOULD YOU NAME IF ASKED FOR ONE?

The uniform definition of wages with the 50 per cent floor.

Not the number of Codes, which is presentational. Not the Inspector's new title, which is cosmetic. The wages definition is the one change that **alters the amount of money owed** in every establishment in the country, and it is the one you will spend your career applying.

Say it like this: the reform's headline is consolidation, but its substance is the wages definition - because every statutory liability is computed **on wages**, and by capping excluded allowances at half of total remuneration the Code raised provident fund, gratuity and bonus liability for every employer who had loaded salaries with allowances, and converted a dispute about nomenclature into an arithmetical determination.

3. What the Codes ABOLISHED ★★★★★☆

A short but heavily examined list, because a question can ask what no longer exists.

- 1 **The Court of Inquiry** - the purely investigative rung of the old five-step ladder. Gone
- 2 **The Labour Court as a separate forum** - merged into the Industrial Tribunal, which now hears both the Second and Third Schedule matters
- 3 **The Board of Conciliation** - not carried forward; conciliation now rests with the Conciliation Officer
- 4 **Scheduled employments** under the Minimum Wages Act - abolished, minimum wage coverage becoming universal
- 5 **The separate EPF Appellate Tribunal** - merged into the **CGIT** acting as the EPF Appellate Tribunal by the Finance Act **2017**, which predates the Codes but belongs on this list

MUST MASTER · THE NEW INDUSTRIAL TRIBUNAL - THE STRUCTURAL CHANGE TO REMEMBER

In place of the Labour Court and the single-member Tribunal, the IR Code creates a **two-member Industrial Tribunal**:

- 1 One **Judicial Member**
- 2 One **Administrative Member**

The **National Industrial Tribunal** is likewise two-member. **This is the single most examinable structural change in the IR Code**, and the reasoning is worth a sentence: industrial adjudication requires both **legal** competence and **administrative or industrial** experience, and the old single-member design supplied only the first.

4. The 2026 Central Rules - the operative numbers



KNOW · FIGURES FROM THE CENTRAL RULES NOTIFIED 8 MAY 2026

- 1 **Minimum wage conversion** - **hourly** = daily wage **divided by 8**; **monthly** = daily wage **multiplied by 26**
- 2 **Overtime** - at **twice** the normal rate, capped at **144 hours per quarter**
- 3 **Creche** - required at **50 employees**, located **within 500 metres**, with a maintenance allowance of **Rs 500 per child** for up to **two** children
- 4 **Grievance Redressal Committee** - at **20 workers**, maximum **10** members
- 5 **Works Committee** - at **100 workers**, maximum **20** members
- 6 **Model Standing Orders 2026** - three Schedules: **A mining**, **B manufacturing**, **C services**
- 7 **Worker Re-skilling Fund** - **15 days' wages**, transferred within **10 days**, paid within **45 days**
- 8 **Contract labour** - **2 per cent annual increment**, a **single all-India licence**, and escalation to the Inspector-cum-Facilitator after **30 days**
- 9 **Gig and platform workers** - registration from age **16**, with a **Universal Account Number**; eligibility after **90 days** with one aggregator or **120 days** across several
- 10 **Annual health examination** - free, for workers above a prescribed age in **docks, mines and construction**
- 11 **Women at night** - permitted with **written consent**, plus **transport**, **adequate numbers**, **CCTV** or equivalent safety arrangements, and **POSH** compliance
- 12 **Appointment letters** - mandatory for every employee

5. The Case For and Against ★★★★★☆

An interview board will ask this. A candidate who can only recite the Government's case, or only the critics', has not understood the reform.

KNOW · THE CASE FOR

- 1 **Compliance simplification.** An employer covered by many Acts formerly maintained separate registers, filed separate returns, faced separate inspections and applied **four different definitions of wages** to one payslip. Now: one definition, one register, one return, one inspection regime
- 2 **Universal minimum wage.** Abolishing scheduled employments brings every worker, organised and unorganised, within a statutory minimum for the first time
- 3 **The floor wage** prevents a race to the bottom between States while preserving upward federal diversity
- 4 **The wages definition closes the allowance loophole**, raising provident fund and gratuity entitlements
- 5 **Social security extended to gig and platform workers** - the first statutory recognition of a workforce that did not exist when the parent Acts were written
- 6 **Fixed-term employment gives lawful flexibility** which is far better for workers than **contract labour**, since a fixed-term employee is on the employer's own rolls with full pro-rata benefits and gratuity after one year
- 7 **Formalisation measures** - mandatory appointment letters, a Universal Account Number, portability for migrants, a national database

KNOW · THE CASE AGAINST

- 1 **The 100-to-300 threshold** removes prior-permission scrutiny from establishments between 100 and 300 workers - a very large number of workers lose that protection
- 2 **The standing orders threshold**, likewise raised to 300, means workers in mid-sized establishments no longer have certified written conditions of service
- 3 **Fewer physical inspections.** Web-based randomised inspection may reduce detection where record-keeping is poor, which is exactly where violations concentrate
- 4 **Fixed-term employment may be used** to keep workers on rolling short contracts indefinitely, never reaching permanency - although the Fifth Schedule unfair labour practice on denying permanent status remains a check
- 5 **The aggregator contribution is on turnover, not on individual workers**, so the link between an individual gig worker's work and his entitlement is weaker than in a contributory scheme
- 6 **State variation persists**, because labour remains Concurrent and States frame their own Rules, so uniformity is partial

MUST MASTER · THE BALANCED FORMULATION TO USE

"The Codes are a genuine simplification of compliance and a genuine extension of coverage - universal minimum wages, gig workers brought within social security, and a wages definition that raises provident fund and gratuity entitlements. The trade-off is that several protective thresholds were raised from 100 to 300, so the reform buys formalisation and flexibility at the cost of scrutiny in mid-sized establishments. Whether the bargain succeeds depends on whether the digital enforcement machinery works, because the Codes rest much more heavily on records and much less on inspection than the statutes they replaced."

That answer states both sides, identifies the trade-off rather than reciting lists, and ends on the empirical question - which is the mark of judgement rather than memorisation.

6. Graded Practice - 40 Questions ★★★★★

6.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. The four Labour Codes replaced how many central Acts?

(a) 24 (b) 27 (c) 29 (d) 44

Q. 2. Which Code was passed in 2019?

(a) Industrial Relations Code (b) Code on Wages (c) Code on Social Security (d) OSH Code

Q. 3. The Codes were brought into force on

(a) 29 September 2020 (b) 21 November 2025 (c) 8 May 2026 (d) 1 April 2026

Q. 4. Final Central Rules under the Codes were notified on

(a) 30 December 2025 (b) 21 November 2025 (c) 8 May 2026 (d) 1 February 2026

Q. 5. The Code subsuming the largest number of Acts is the

(a) Code on Wages (b) Industrial Relations Code (c) Code on Social Security (d) OSH Code

Q. 6. The Code on Social Security subsumes

(a) 3 Acts (b) 4 Acts (c) 9 Acts (d) 13 Acts

Q. 7. Under the OSH Code, the factory threshold with power is

(a) 10 (b) 20 (c) 30 (d) 40

Q. 8. Under the IR Code, standing orders are required at

(a) 100 workers (b) 200 workers (c) 300 workers (d) 500 workers

Q. 9. Under the OSH Code, the contract labour threshold is

(a) 20 (b) 30 (c) 50 (d) 100

Q. 10. A Grievance Redressal Committee is required at

(a) 20 workers (b) 50 workers (c) 100 workers (d) 300 workers

Q. 11. A fixed-term employee becomes entitled to gratuity after

(a) 1 year (b) 3 years (c) 5 years (d) 10 years

Q. 12. The new designation replacing "Inspector" is

(a) Compliance Officer (b) Inspector-cum-Facilitator (c) Facilitating Authority (d) Labour Facilitator

Q. 13. The Worker Re-skilling Fund contribution is

(a) 7 days' wages (b) 15 days' wages (c) 30 days' wages (d) 45 days' wages

Q. 14. An aggregator's contribution for gig and platform workers is

(a) 1 to 2 per cent of turnover (b) 5 per cent of turnover (c) 12 per cent of wages (d) 8.33 per cent of wages

Q. 15. Under the Central Rules, the monthly minimum wage is the daily wage multiplied by

(a) 24 (b) 26 (c) 28 (d) 30

6.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 16. Which one of the following thresholds did not change under the Codes?

(a) Factory with power (b) Standing orders (c) EPF coverage (d) Contract labour

Q. 17. Which one of the following did the Codes abolish?

(a) The Works Committee (b) The Court of Inquiry (c) The Conciliation Officer (d) The National Industrial Tribunal

Q. 18. Under the IR Code, the Industrial Tribunal consists of

(a) a single presiding officer (b) a Judicial Member and an Administrative Member (c) a chairman and two assessors (d) three judicial members

Q. 19. Two separate provisions both moved from 100 to 300. They are

(a) the Works Committee and the Grievance Redressal Committee (b) standing orders, and prior permission for lay-off, retrenchment and closure (c) the canteen and the ambulance room (d) EPF and ESI coverage

Q. 20. The single most significant substantive change made by the Codes is

(a) the reduction of many Acts to four Codes (b) the uniform definition of wages with the 50 per cent rule (c) the renaming of the Inspector (d) the raising of the factory threshold

Q. 21. Under the Code on Wages, the concept of scheduled employments has been

(a) retained (b) abolished, minimum wage coverage becoming universal (c) extended to the unorganised sector only (d) replaced by the floor wage

Q. 22. The floor wage is fixed by

(a) each State Government (b) the Central Government (c) the Central Advisory Board (d) the Inspector-cum-Facilitator

Q. 23. A union is recognised as the sole negotiating union if it has the support of

(a) 20 per cent of workers (b) 33 per cent of workers (c) 51 per cent of workers (d) 66 per cent of workers

Q. 24. Representation on a negotiating council requires the support of at least

(a) 10 per cent (b) 20 per cent (c) 25 per cent (d) 51 per cent

Q. 25. The Codes made mandatory for every employee

(a) a trade union membership (b) an appointment letter (c) a fixed-term contract (d) an annual bonus

Q. 26. Under the Central Rules, overtime is capped at

(a) 50 hours per quarter (b) 100 hours per quarter (c) 125 hours per quarter (d) 144 hours per quarter

Q. 27. Gig and platform workers may register from the age of

(a) 14 (b) 16 (c) 18 (d) 21

Q. 28. Gig worker eligibility arises after

(a) 30 days with one aggregator (b) 90 days with one aggregator or 120 days across several (c) 180 days with one aggregator (d) one year in the sector

Q. 29. The creche criterion under the Codes changed from

(a) 50 employees to 30 women (b) 30 women workers to 50 employees (c) 100 employees to 50 employees (d) 30 employees to 50 women

Q. 30. Contract labour is prohibited under the OSH Code in

(a) all activities (b) core activities, subject to specified exceptions (c) non-core activities only (d) seasonal activities only

6.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard**Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:**

List-I (Code)	List-II (Acts subsumed)
A. Code on Wages, 2019	1. 13
B. Industrial Relations Code, 2020	2. 9
C. Code on Social Security, 2020	3. 4
D. OSH Code, 2020	4. 3

(a) A-3 B-4 C-2 D-1 (b) A-3 B-2 C-4 D-1 (c) A-4 B-3 C-2 D-1 (d) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3

Q. 32. Consider the following statements:

- 1 The Codes raised the factory threshold with power from 10 to 20 workers.
- 2 The Codes raised the EPF coverage threshold from 20 to 50 employees.
- 3 The Codes raised the standing orders threshold from 100 to 300 workers.

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 33. An establishment employs 200 workers and retrenches one in 2026. Which one of the following is correct?

(a) Prior permission of the appropriate Government is required (b) Prior permission is not required, the threshold now being 300, but notice, compensation and the Re-skilling Fund contribution remain due (c) No compensation is payable (d) Three months' notice is required but no compensation

Q. 34. Which one of the following was not an innovation of the Codes?

(a) Fixed-term employment (b) The negotiating union and negotiating council (c) The Works Committee (d) The Worker Re-skilling Fund

Q. 35. Consider the following statements about the IR Code's dispute machinery:

- 1 The Court of Inquiry was abolished.
- 2 The Labour Court was merged into the Industrial Tribunal.
- 3 The Industrial Tribunal now has a Judicial Member and an Administrative Member.

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 36. A worker retrenched after 6 years with last drawn wages of Rs 20,000 per month receives, by way of retrenchment compensation and the Re-skilling Fund contribution together,

(a) Rs 60,000 (b) Rs 70,000 (c) Rs 80,000 (d) Rs 1,20,000

Q. 37. Which one of the following statements is not correct?

(a) The notice period for a strike remained 14 days but was extended to all industrial establishments
(b) The leave qualifying period under the OSH Code was reduced from 240 to 180 days
(c) The bonus eligibility ceiling was raised from Rs 21,000 to Rs 30,000
(d) The supervisory wage limit in the definition of worker was raised to Rs 18,000

Q. 38. The strongest single argument against the Codes is that

(a) they reduced the number of statutes
(b) raising the prior-permission and standing-orders thresholds to 300 removes protective scrutiny from workers in mid-sized establishments
(c) they introduced a floor wage
(d) they recognised gig workers

Q. 39. Consider the following statements:

- 1 The Codes rest more heavily on records and less on physical inspection than the statutes they replaced.
- 2 Labour remains on the Concurrent List, so States continue to frame their own Rules.
- 3 Uniformity across States is therefore complete.

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only (c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 40. A question states: "Under the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947, prior permission for retrenchment is required in an industrial establishment employing..." The correct answer is

(a) 100 or more workmen, because the stem names the 1947 Act
(b) 300 or more workers, because that is the present position
(c) either, since both are acceptable
(d) 50 or more workmen

7. Answers and Explanations

7.1 Level 1

Q	Ans	Explanation
1	c	29 , split 4-3-9-13
2	b	Code on Wages, 2019 - the only one of 2019
3	b	21 November 2025
4	c	8 May 2026
5	d	OSH Code , with 13 Acts
6	c	Nine - and it is your Code
7	b	20 with power, 40 without
8	c	300
9	c	50
10	a	20 workers, maximum 10 members
11	a	One year - the most examinable single change
12	b	Inspector-cum-Facilitator
13	b	15 days' wages , credited in 10 days, paid in 45
14	a	1 to 2 per cent of turnover , capped at 5 per cent of payments to such workers
15	b	26 - working days, not calendar days

7.2 Level 2

Q	Ans	Explanation
16	c	EPF coverage stayed at 20 . So did ESI at 10, bonus at 20 and maternity at 10. The Codes changed fewer numbers than the publicity suggests
17	b	The Court of Inquiry . Also the Labour Court and the Board of Conciliation. The Works Committee, Conciliation Officer and National Tribunal all survive
18	b	Judicial Member and Administrative Member - legal competence plus industrial experience
19	b	Standing orders , and prior permission for lay-off, retrenchment and closure. Same numbers, different subjects
20	b	The uniform wages definition with the 50 per cent rule - it alters the amount of money owed everywhere
21	b	Abolished , coverage becoming universal
22	b	The Central Government . States fix the minimum wage at or above the floor
23	c	51 per cent of workers on the muster roll
24	b	20 per cent , one representative per 20 per cent
25	b	Appointment letters - a small provision with large formalisation effects, because a worker without one cannot easily prove employment
26	d	144 hours per quarter

Q	Ans	Explanation
27	b	16
28	b	90 days with one aggregator or 120 days across several
29	b	From 30 women workers to 50 employees - childcare treated as a parental rather than a women's need
30	b	Core activities , subject to the three exceptions - work ordinarily done through a contractor, work not requiring full-time workers, or a sudden increase in volume

7.3 Level 3

Q	Ans	Explanation
31	a	A-3 Wages 4; B-4 IR 3; C-2 Social Security 9; D-1 OSH 13
32	c	1 and 3 only . Statement 2 is wrong - EPF coverage remained at 20 . This is the commonest false assumption about the Codes
33	b	The threshold is now 300 , so no permission is needed at 200 workers - but notice, 15 days per year compensation, and the Re-skilling Fund contribution all remain due. Option (a) applies the superseded figure
34	c	The Works Committee dates from the Industrial Disputes Act, 1947 . The other three are genuine Code innovations
35	d	All three correct
36	b	Compensation = 6 x 15 days' pay . 15 days on Rs 20,000 = Rs 10,000 , so Rs 60,000 . Plus the Re-skilling Fund's 15 days' wages = Rs 10,000 . Total Rs 70,000 . Notice pay of Rs 20,000 would be additional but was not asked
37	c	The bonus eligibility ceiling remained Rs 21,000 . The other three statements are correct
38	b	The 100-to-300 thresholds remove prior-permission scrutiny and certified standing orders from mid-sized establishments. (c) and (d) are arguments for the Codes
39	a	1 and 2 only . Statement 3 is wrong - because labour is Concurrent and States frame their own Rules, uniformity is partial , not complete
40	a	100 , because the stem names the 1947 Act . Read the statutory name in the stem before choosing between the pair - this is the single most useful exam habit in Module 2

8. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F2.9 - THE FOUR CODES

DATES Wages Code **2019**, other three **2020** · **IN FORCE 21 NOV 2025** · **FINAL CENTRAL RULES 8 MAY 2026** · **29 Acts replaced** · **4-3-9-13**

READING THE STEM old Act named → **old** figure · Code named, or "as amended" or "at present" → **Code** figure · bare stem for a 2026 paper → prefer the **Code** figure

CHANGED factory **10/20** → **20/40** · standing orders **100** → **300** · prior permission **100** → **300** · contract labour **20** → **50** · creche **30 women** → **50 employees** · supervisory limit **Rs 10,000** → **Rs 18,000** · leave qualifying **240** → **180** · fixed-term gratuity **5 years** → **1 year** · wage claims limitation → **3 years** · strike notice extended from **public utility only to ALL establishments**

UNCHANGED - THE ROWS CANDIDATES GET WRONG EPF **20** · ESI **10** · bonus **20** · maternity **10** · bonus ceilings **Rs 21,000 and Rs 7,000** · Works Committee **100** · migrants **5** · construction **10** · rest rooms **150** · ambulance room **500** · Safety Committee **50**

NINE INNOVATIONS uniform wages definition + **50% rule** · floor wage + **universal coverage** · fixed-term employment · negotiating union **51% / council 20%** · gig and platform workers + **aggregator 1-2% of turnover** · Worker Re-skilling Fund **15/10/45** ·

Inspector-cum-Facilitator with **web-based randomised inspection** · mandatory appointment letters · single registration, licence and return · plus **widened migrant definition with portability** and the **core activity** prohibition

ABOLISHED Court of Inquiry · Labour Court as a separate forum · Board of Conciliation · scheduled employments · (and, by the Finance Act **2017**, the separate **EPF Appellate Tribunal**, merged into the **CGIT**)

NEW TRIBUNAL two members - one **JUDICIAL**, one **ADMINISTRATIVE** · same for the **National Industrial Tribunal** · hears **both** Schedules

2026 RULES NUMBERS hourly **/8** · monthly **x26** · OT **twice**, cap **144 per quarter** · creche **50 employees, 500 metres, Rs 500 per child for 2 children** · GRC **20 workers, max 10** · Works Cttee **100, max 20** · Model Standing Orders **A mining, B manufacturing, C services** · Re-skilling **15/10/45** · contract labour **2% annual increment**, single all-India licence, escalation after **30 days** · gig registration from **16** with a **UAN**, eligibility **90/120 days** · women at night with **written consent + transport + adequate numbers + CCTV + POSH**

IF ASKED FOR ONE CHANGE the **uniform wages definition with the 50% floor** - because every liability is computed on wages, so it raises PF, gratuity and bonus everywhere and turns a nomenclature dispute into arithmetic

THE BALANCED ANSWER genuine simplification and genuine extension of coverage - universal minimum wages, gig workers inside social security, higher PF and gratuity entitlements - **traded against** raised thresholds that remove scrutiny from mid-sized establishments; and the whole bargain **depends on whether digital enforcement works**, because the Codes rest on **records** rather than **inspection**

9. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F2.9 - THE PAIRS**4-3-9-13 = 29 · IN FORCE 21 NOV 2025 · RULES 8 MAY 2026****CHANGED** factory **10/20 → 20/40** · standing orders **100 → 300** · permission **100 → 300** · contract labour **20 → 50** · creche **30 women → 50 employees** · supervisor **10,000 → 18,000** · leave **240 → 180** · fixed-term gratuity **5 → 1 year****UNCHANGED** EPF **20** · ESI **10** · BONUS **20** · MATERNITY **10** · **21,000 / 7,000** · WORKS CTTEE **100** · MIGRANTS **5****ABOLISHED** Court of Inquiry · Labour Court · Board of Conciliation · scheduled employments**NEW TRIBUNAL = JUDICIAL + ADMINISTRATIVE MEMBER****NEW THINGS** wages 50% rule · floor wage · fixed-term · **51% / 20%** · gig + aggregator **1-2% turnover** · re-skilling **15/10/45** · Inspector-cum-Facilitator · appointment letters · single licence**RULES /8 and x26** · OT **144/quarter** · creche **50 / 500 m / Rs 500 / 2 children** · GRC **20 max 10** · gig **16, 90/120 days****THE EXAM HABIT READ THE STATUTORY NAME IN THE STEM FIRST.** "Under the ID Act 1947" = **100**. "Under the IR Code" = **300**.**THE ONE-CHANGE ANSWER** the **uniform definition of wages with the 50% floor****ACTION · NEXT IN THE FOUNDATION TRACK****Chapter F2.10 - Labour Administration and Enforcement** closes Module 2: the Ministry of Labour and Employment and its attached offices, the Chief Labour Commissioner, DGMS, DGFASLI, the tripartite bodies including the Indian Labour Conference, the Labour Bureau and CPI-IW, and the inspection and prosecution machinery. Then the build moves to **Module 3 - Social Security and EPFO**, the subject of the post itself.